

people appear more appealing while facial features can be exaggerated in high contrast shots. Also the skin may seem to be rougher and often less desirable.

To achieve the effect of an evenly distributed light source either a flash diffuser or a bounced flash may be used. Also, though counterintuitive, aiming the flash away from the subject can actually enhance the appearance. This explains the use of umbrellas while clicking in studios, to first bounce off and make the flash seem to be coming from a larger, more distributed source. The only problem with this approach is the undeniable reduction in the intensity. Another limitation is the how it cannot be used outdoor photography where subjects are less contained. Flash diffusers are other common alternatives. It can usually be simply attached over the camera flash and is a piece of translucent plastic scattering the light from the flash. Not much effective outdoors but diffusers can significantly soften the light on subjects in indoor situations. To be remembered here is that overly diffused light is also not always desired, causing the subjects to sometimes look two dimensional and flat.

Daylight has an approximate color temperature of 5000K, and most flash units try to mimic this value. But white balance matching can be a problem when using flashes if the ambient light temperature is substantially different from this mean value. This surrounding light will appear to have a certain tint in such cases, and will be most apparent with artificial lighting or when the flash ratios makes the ambient and flash light sources completely distinguishable. This problem may also arise when the flash bounces off a colored surface like a painted wall etc. but then the effect is less pronounced as the ambient light is also getting the same obstructions. In a way this is not always a problem as the flash's white balance can be intentionally altered to achieve a certain effect like to better match indoor incandescent lighting or make it look like a sunset.

Now your camera flash can be an on-camera one or an off-camera one, with both having their own plus and minus points. An on camera flash can



Flash White Balance distortion